



Eken Leopard Tablet

Eken Electronics launches Leopard tablet ranging from ₹6,900 – ₹11,999 depending upon 7-inch, 8-inch, 9.7-inch screen size

Mozilla Firefox Metro

Mozilla releases Firefox metro preview for Windows 8 modern UI interface

HOW WE TESTED

We played games. A lot of games!

PC

- F1 2012
- Grid
- NFS: Shift 2
- Off-Road drive
- CS: Global Offensive
- Torchlight 2

PS3

- Gran Turismo 5

Test Rig

- CPU: Intel Core i7 875k
- RAM: 4GB DDRIII 1600MHz
- HDD: Kingston SSD + WD Velociraptor
- GPU: Elitegroup nVidia GeForce 560
- Monitor: BenQ GL2750

Console

- PlayStation 3 with Dell S2740L

and then discovers that there are no bundled batteries and all the nearby stores are closed for the weekend. After firing off emails to Logitech, demanding that they send the adapter ASAP, we settled down to some indignant muttering about how inconsiderate people are and how they don't care about people's feelings (no offence to Logitech here, just a gamer's rant).

That is of course, till we finally got the adapter a few days later. All was forgiven and forgotten and we smugly settled into our seat and had a go with the wheel. Everyone did actually and it was quite some time before we actually got down to trying to review the wheel more objectively.

Gaming experience

We tried out quite a few games with this wheel and we must say, the experience was a lot of fun. The more arcade-type games such as GRID were fun to play, but games like Shift 2 and GT5 really came into their own with this wheel. The force-feedback we felt was really strong and collisions would even have the wheel slipping out of our hands. Taking a corner at speed would have us really fighting the wheel and drifting was also quite a challenge. Overall, a really fun experience.

One major complaint we have with the wheel is with the gear shift. The paddle-

shifters are fun and functional, but the actual gear lever feels very flimsy and doesn't have the weight and feel of a proper gear shift. We avoided using it as much as possible and stuck to the paddle-shifts or automatic transmission. A better designed gear-shift would have really placed this wheel at the top of any racing fanatic's must have list. Especially when you consider the price tag.

We had a few of the non-drivers among us asking if the experience was similar to driving a real car and the answer to that is a very loud and resounding NO. The wheel is a lot of fun to use but don't for a

wheel and on the gear assembly which can be mapped any way you like, not to mention paddle-shifters with the steering wheel. Overall, the wheel is quite well-built and feels very sturdy. The wheel and gear assembly have clamps that will allow you to attach them quite tightly to any surface, though we recommend putting in a strip of rubber between the clamps for a better grip as we managed to yank off the gear assembly in some of our more frenzied moments.

Verdict: Officially priced at a prodigious ₹30,000, this is insanely expensive considering the features on offer. Even at ₹10,000 less (as seen on

Company	Steelseries	Nitho	Nitho	Logitech
Model	Simiraceway SRW-S1	Drive Pro V16	Drive Pro 3	G27
Price (in ₹)	10,168	4,499	4,903	29,899
Features				
Analogue steering	Y	Y	Y	Y
Analogue pedals	Y	N	N	Y
Force feedback	N	N	N	Y
Steering movement (degrees)	360	270	270	900

moment think that driving a real car is replicated that well. What we realized while playing those various games is that the wheel isn't of much use in helping us win races in arcade games like GRID (fun though the experience was), but almost essential with simulation games like Shift 2 and GT5 which require precise analogue inputs.

With the G27 you basically get a wheel (duh), a set of floor-pedals (accelerator, brake and clutch) and a 6 speed + reverse gear shift. The gear mechanism and pedals connect to the steering column which connects to the PC and PS3 via USB. Additional power is required for the wheel motors and the wheel will not work without it. There are additional buttons on the

Flipkart), this is very expensive and you need to be a really hardcore racing fanatic with money to splurge to want this wheel enough to buy it.

Nitho Drive PRO V16 and Drive PRO 3

These two wheels from NITHO are low-budget racing wheels and while they're quite decent, after playing with the monster that is the G27, we could only look at these with a certain sense of detachment.

The wheels are of decent quality but they are built to a price and feel cheap. Both wheels have suction cups at the bottom which while useful, do not provide as much grip as we would like, and there is a bit of see-sawing when playing a

input is not linear and precise, your actual in-game experience will not be as satisfying and you might as well play with a gamepad or keyboard.

Logitech G27

This is the most expensive product we got and frankly the most attention grabbing. The moment we set eyes on this, we just knew that we had to play with it. As we scrambled to hunt out a worthy game to put this beast through its paces we couldn't help but feel just a little bit excited, giggling randomly with huge grins plastered across our faces. The huge disappointment we felt when we found out that we hadn't received the power adapter that goes with the wheel can only be felt by a child who receives the most awesome toy in the world



Logitech G27